TUI

Quick Start

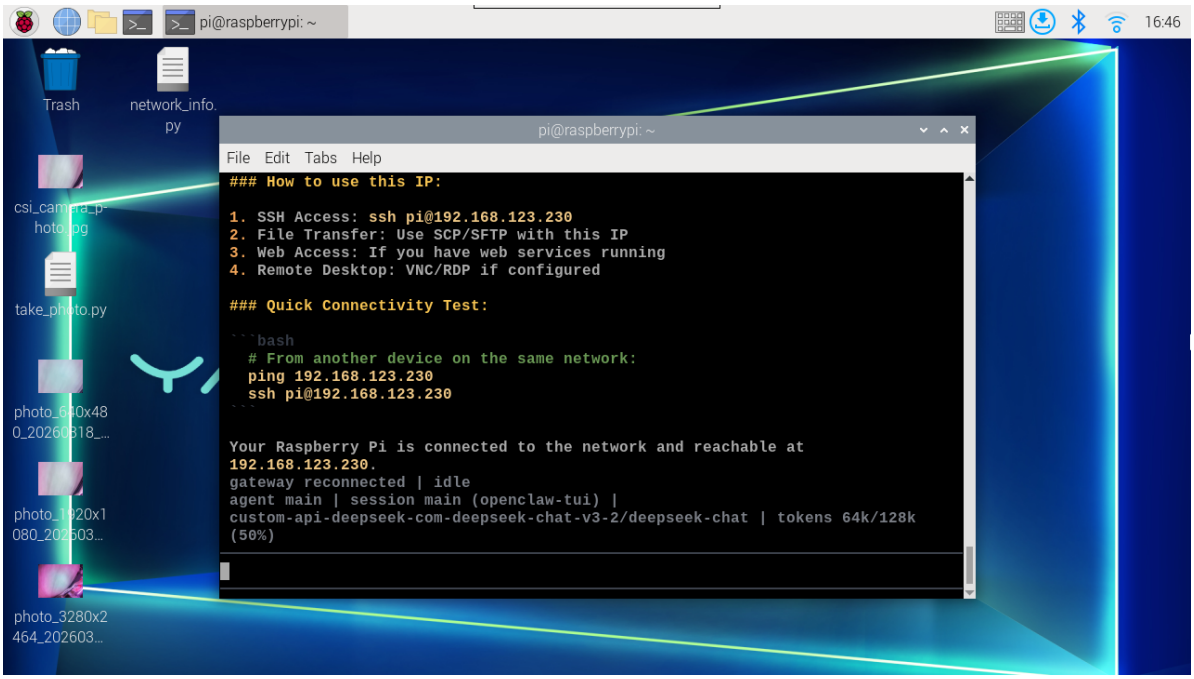
1. Star Gateway. (Usually Gateway has auto-started, no need to run this command)

```
openclaw gateway
```

2. Open TUI.

```
openclaw tui
```

3. Type message and press Enter.



Remote Gateway:

```
openclaw tui --url ws://<host>:<port> --token <gateway-token>
```

If your Gateway uses password authentication, use `--password`.

What You See

- Title bar: connection URL, current agent, current session.
- Chat log: user messages, assistant replies, system notifications, tool cards.
- Status line: connection/run state (connecting, running, streaming, idle, error).
- Footer: connection status + agent + session + model + think/verbose/reasoning + token count + delivery status.
- Input: text editor with autocomplete.

Mental Model: Agent + Session

- Agent is a unique identifier (e.g., `main`, `research`). Gateway exposes list.

- Sessions belong to the current agent.
- Session keys are stored as agent::.
  - If you type `/session main`, TUI expands it to `agent:<currentAgent>:main`.
  - If you type `/session agent:other:main`, you explicitly switch to that agent's session.
- Session scope:
  - `per-sender` (default): multiple sessions per agent.
  - `global`: TUI always uses `global` session (selector may be empty).
- Current agent + session is always visible in footer.

Sending + Delivery

- Messages are sent to Gateway; not delivered to provider by default.
- Enable delivery:
  - `/deliver on`
  - or settings panel
  - or start with `openclaw tui --deliver`

Selectos + Overlays

- Model selector: lists available models and sets session override.
- Agent selector: choose different agent.
- Session selector: shows only current agent's sessions.
- Settings: toggle delivery, tool output expansion, and thinking visibility.

Keyoard Shortcuts

- Enter: send message
- Esc: abort active run
- Ctrl+C: clear input (press twice to exit)
- Ctrl+D: exit
- Ctrl+L: model selector
- Ctrl+G: agent selector
- Ctrl+P: session selector
- Ctrl+O: toggle tool output expansion
- Ctrl+T: toggle thinking visibility (reload history)

Slash Commands

Core:

- `/help`
- `/status`
- `/agent <id>` (or `/agents`)
- `/session <key>` (or `/sessions`)
- `/model <provider/model>` (or `/models`)

Session control:

- `/think <off|minimal|low|medium|high>`
- `/verbose <on|full|off>`
- `/reasoning <on|off|stream>`
- `/usage <off|tokens|full>`

- `/elevated <on|off|ask|full>` (alias: `/elev`)
- `/activation <mention|always>`
- `/deliver <on|off>`

Session lifecycle:

- `/new` or `/reset` (reset session)
- `/abort` (abort active run)
- `/settings`
- `/exit`

Other Gateway slash commands (e.g., `/context`) are forwarded to Gateway and displayed as system output. See [Slash Commands](#).

Local Shell Commands

- Lines prefixed with `!` run local shell commands on the TUI host.
- TUI prompts once per session to allow local execution; refusal disables `!` for that session.
- Commands run in TUI working directory in a fresh non-interactive shell (no persistent `cd`/environment variables).
- Standalone `!` is sent as regular message; leading space doesn't trigger local execution.

Tool Output

- Tool calls display as cards with parameters + results.
- Ctrl+O toggles between collapsed/expanded view.
- While tool is running, partial updates stream to the same card.

History + Streaming

- On connect, TUI loads recent history (default 200 messages).
- Streaming responses update in-place until complete.
- TUI also listens to agent tool events for richer tool cards.

Connection Details

- TUI registers with Gateway as `mode: "tui"`.
- Reconnects show system message; event gaps appear in log.

Options

- `--url <url>`: Gateway WebSocket URL (default from config or `ws://127.0.0.1:<port>`)
- `--token <token>`: Gateway token (if required)
- `--password <password>`: Gateway password (if required)
- `--session <key>`: session key (default: `main`, or `global` if scope is global)
- `--deliver`: deliver assistant replies to provider (default off)
- `--thinking <level>`: override thinking level for sends
- `--timeout-ms <ms>`: agent timeout in milliseconds (default from `agents.defaults.timeoutSeconds`)
- `--history-limit <n>`: number of history entries to load (default 200)

Troubleshooting

No output after sending message:

- Run `/status` in TUI to confirm Gateway is connected and idle/busy.
- Check Gateway logs: `openclaw logs --follow`.
- Confirm agent can run: `openclaw status` and `openclaw models status`.
- If you expect messages to appear in chat channels, enable delivery (`/deliver on` or `--deliver`).

Troubleshooting

- `disconnected`: ensure Gateway is running and your `--url/--token/--password` are correct.
- No agents in selector: check `openclaw agents list` and your routing configuration.
- Session selector empty: you might be in global scope or don't have sessions yet.

For more TI content, refer to: [TUI - OpenClaw]